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Los Angeles WAVE NEWSPAPERS

Vol 109 • No. 45

STREET BEAT

'Is the end of Daylight Saving Time a good thing?'



ARNETTA MACK
INGLEWOOD

"I don't think my generation uses it all that much, so it doesn't matter. If anything, it keeps you in a bubble. That's not good."



AJA JOHNSON
LONG BEACH

"I prefer Daylight Saving Time *because I enjoy sunsets and when the sun goes down early,* I don't get to enjoy the sunset or a stroll at the beach after work."



GINGER CAMPBELL
LOS ANGELES

"When we turn the clock back it's like dark at 5 o'clock. I can't use the extra hour in the morning. I'd rather have the extra hour at night."



L.A. mayor's race

'Too close to call'

Winner may not be known for days, election officials say

BY JOSE HERRERA
Contributing Writer

LOS ANGELES (CNS) — City Councilwoman Nithya Raman was leading Mayor Karen Bass in the race for mayor Nov. 4 as ballots were still being counted in a race observers say remains too close to call.

The latest figures released Nov. 4 by the Los Angeles County Registrar-Recorder/County Clerk's Office showed Raman with 405,193 votes, or 51.67%, compared with 379,069 votes, or 48.33%, for Bass.

With ballot-counting expected to continue through the week and coming weeks, the winner of the race could remain unknown well into the month.

Some pundits speculated that Bass' narrow early lead election night could prove problematic for the incumbent. They noted that Raman's primary support base of younger voters tends to cast ballots closer to Election Day and that she could overtake Bass as vote-counting continues.

Bass, however, remained defiant as she spoke to supporters in Hollywood election night. She hailed Democratic victories across the country and spoke positively about the future of Los Angeles.

"Four years ago, you gave me the honor of a lifetime to serve as the mayor of the city that raised me, the city my parents chose to build a life in, and the city I have spent my entire life fighting for," Bass said. "And every single day, I have carried that responsibility with me."

She touted her work to recover from last year's wildfires, oppose federal immigration raids in the city and reduce homelessness.

"I have seen communities come together to stand up for one another, and I have seen people refuse to give up on the city, even when challenges before us seemed overwhelming," Bass said. "That is the Los Angeles I know. That is the city that I love, and this is the Los Angeles that I will never stop fighting for."

At her election night party at

See MAYOR, Page 11

Bass to supporters: "It ain't over" See Page 2

Raman to supporters: "I'm very hopeful" See Page 2



Mayor Karen Bass speaks to supporters at the Loews Hollywood Hotel Nov. 3. The mayor was trailing City Councilwoman Nithya Raman Nov. 4 after leading at the start of vote counting election night.

Photo by Dennis Freeman



City Councilwoman Nithya Raman speaks to her supporters at the Greek Theatre Nov. 3. Raman overcame an early lead by Mayor Karen Bass, to lead by 17,000 votes in vote counting Nov. 4.

Photo by Stephen Oduntan

Harris-Dawson facing recall

Effort fuels debate over accountability

BY STEPHEN ODUNTAN
Contributing Writer

SOUTH LOS ANGELES — A campaign to recall City Council President Marqueece Harris-Dawson is turning years of frustration over neighborhood conditions, public spending and accountability into a direct challenge to his leadership on the City Council and in South Los Angeles.

Recall organizers accuse the



Former council aide leads in 9th District

FROM CITY NEWS SERVICE

SOUTH LOS ANGELES — Former City Council aide Jose Ugarte was ahead of Estuardo Mazariegos in the race to replace City Councilman Curren Price in the 9th District.

Ugarte, a former deputy chief of staff to Price, led Mazariegos, co-director of the L.A. chapter of the Alliance of Californians for Community Empowerment, by 1,936 votes early Nov. 4. Ugarte had received 13,123



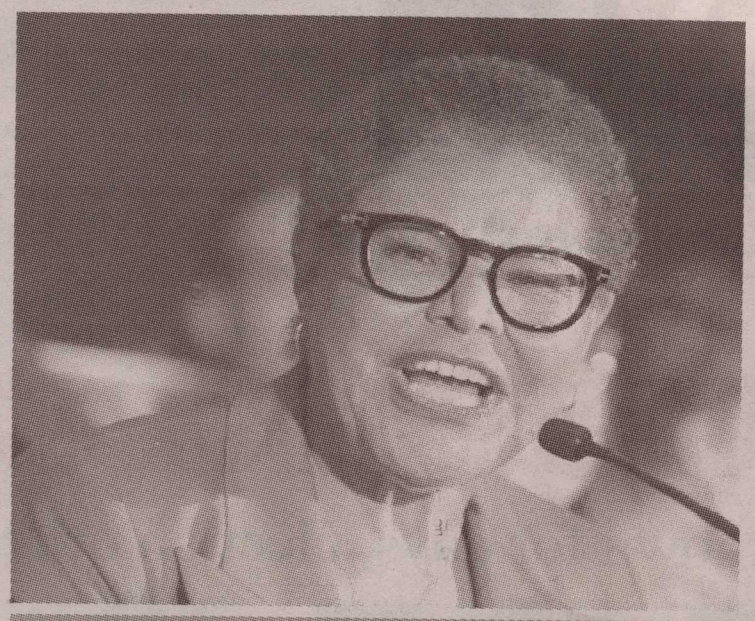
Bass to supporters: 'It ain't over till it's over'

By Dennis J. Freeman
Contributing Writer

LOS ANGELES — Mayor Karen Bass came to her joint Election Night watch party at the Loews Hollywood Hotel clearly fired up and ready to go.

After serving as the city's chief executive for four years — and having faced turbulent times — Bass had a slight lead over mayoral rival Nithya Raman when she took the stage and delivered a speech that seemed to inspire and galvanize her supporters.

"Let me just say it takes a while to count the vote in our city, but pretty soon we will know," Bass told her followers election night. " And I am confident with all of the work that is done here that we will achieve victory. I love Los Angeles. I believe in this city and I will always fight for the city we deserve."



Mayor Karen Bass addresses her supporters election night at the Loews Hollywood Hotel. After leading the vote count early, Bass was trailing City Councilwoman Nithya Raman by 17,000 votes as of 4 p.m. Nov. 4 in her race for reelection.

Photo by Dennis Freeman

"As we await the votes to be counted, there is one thing that I can tell you with absolute certainty: I have never been more proud of our city, more grateful for its people and more hopeful about what we can accomplish together," she added.

Speaking to another group of supporters earlier, Bass was perhaps even more blunt in her analysis: "It ain't over," she said, "till it's over."

By the early morning Nov. 4, Bass' lead over City Councilwoman Raman had evaporated, with Raman holding a 51-49 percentage lead with plenty of votes remaining to be counted. Bass trailed by 17,000 votes as of 4 p.m. Nov. 4.

Bass volunteer Teresa Hillery, a Los Angeles city attorney, said she supported the mayor because she believes Bass puts people first above everything else.

"I live downtown and I believe she is the best person for downtown, in terms of moving the economic hub forward," said Hillery, also a real estate attorney. "Downtown is like the major economic hub for Los Angeles."

The Rev. William D. Smart Jr has known Bass for three decades. Founder of the "Hurting and Hungry" ministry, Smart said that the compassion that Bass has shown to others is something that has always been at the core of who the mayor is as an individual.

"Her heart has been there all along," said Smart, president of the local chapter of the Southern Christian Leader Conference. "You need to measure her by her sensitivity to people. That was always important for the 30 years I've known her. … She put people over politics."

City Councilman Curren Price agreed, saying that Bass is someone who represents all Angelenos in the way she handles herself and how she tackles hard issues head-on without flinching.

"She has been a leader that has brought people together. She's demonstrated the ability to collaborate, to tackle tough problems, and actually be resilient," Price said. "I think that she's got history … a track record of working together, dealing with problems and really facing the future."

Among those attending election night celebration were Price (District 9), Los Angeles City Council President Marqueece-Harris Dawson (District 8), and Councilman Hugo Soto-Martinez (District 13).

Soto-Martinez said he threw his allegiance to Bass because he has been familiar with how she gets things done.

"I've known the mayor's work for many years," Soto-Martinez said. "I grew up in South Los Angeles. I know of the work she was involved in … the Community Coalition, followed her career. I've had the pleasure of working with her for almost four years.

"We speak the same language, how to organize. We came from the same community in L.A., so there's a lot of familiarity. We work well together."

Dennis Freeman is a freelance reporter for Wave Newspapers.

Raman's election-night surge fuels hope among supporters

By Stephen Oduntan
Contributing Writer

LOS ANGELES — Shortly after 11 p.m. on election night, as the November chill settled over the Greek Theatre plaza, Nithya Raman stepped before a crowd of supporters whose enthusiasm showed little sign of cooling.

"Do you love Los Angeles?" she asked. "Are you ready for an L.A. that loves you back?"

The question drew cheers from supporters who had spent hours watching election returns, dancing and hoping for an upset. But Raman, challenging incumbent Mayor Karen Bass, stopped short of declaring victory.

"There are still a lot of ballots to count, and we're gonna let that count finish," she said. "I'm hopeful. I'm very hopeful."

By early the next morning, Raman had overtaken Bass after trailing in the initial returns. As of 4 p.m. Nov. 14, Raman held a 51-49 percentage lead with Bass trailing by 17,000 votes. Vote counting was expected to continue through at least Nov. 6.

Stephen Oduntan is a freelance writer for Wave Newspapers.

Raman's election night gathering reflected demands for change in a city struggling with homelessness, housing costs and dissatisfaction with basic services.

Among supporters, hopes for change centered on housing, city services and accountability.

Rodney Leggett of Sherman Oaks said housing construction was central to his support.

"We have to have way more housing built — affordable housing, market-rate housing, both of them," he said, arguing that increased supply could help working-class residents and artists remain in Los Angeles.

Michael Hobson of Koreatown wanted closer scrutiny of homelessness spending, better street services and changes in police funding priorities.

He said he came to the gathering to witness a potentially historic moment, but recognized that supporting a candidate did not eliminate the need for public pressure.

"When Nithya wins, we will see what the mayor can do, and then we'll also see where we have to push it," he said.

Raman credited a coalition of labor unions, housing advocates, environmental organizations and progressive groups with building her campaign. More than 11,000 people registered to volunteer, she told supporters.



Surrounded by family and supporters, City Councilwoman Nithya Raman speaks to news crews Nov. 3. Raman held a 17,000-vote lead over Mayor Karen Bass in the Los Angeles mayoral election with plenty of votes yet to be counted.

Courtesy photo

Campaign manager Ian Manheimer recalled joining Raman's first City Council campaign in 2020, when the operation ran from a garage.

"What started in an actual garage with just a couple people has grown into this," he said.

Among the elected officials supporting Raman were Los Angeles County Supervisor Lindsey Horvath and City Controller Kenneth Mejia.

Horvath acknowledged past disagreements with Raman, but stressed the need for city-county cooperation.

"No more finger-pointing, just problem-solving," she told supporters.

UNITE HERE Local 11 Co-President Ada Briceño highlighted the struggles of hospitality workers who can no longer afford to live near their workplaces.

Raman pledged to expand housing construction and create good-paying union jobs.

"If you work in this city, you should be able to afford to live in the area," she said.

She also invoked Los Angeles' history of migration and immigration, recalling Black southerners fleeing Jim Crow who, in her words, "sought a home that welcomed them," along with Salvadorans escaping civil war, Iranians fleeing political unrest and Armenians displaced from their homelands. Her tribute extended to the city's cultural legacy, including the jazz that once flourished along Central Avenue.

But translating Raman's vision of opportunity into meaningful improvements for Angelenos could prove far more difficult.

Tom Hogen-Esch, a political science professor at Cal State Northridge, pointed to structural limits on the mayor's authority.

"The mayor has some power, [but] can be checked by the City Council in things like the budget," he said. "And then the mayor has very little control over the bureaucracy itself."

He told a reporter that the division of authority between elected officials and independent city departments makes it difficult for any mayor to deliver sweeping improvements.

"People just don't really have a lot of faith that L.A. city government is going to be working for them," Hogen-Esch said.

Hogen-Esch also questioned whether replacing Bass with Raman would substantially improve city services, cautioning against expectations of "magical changes" simply because voters elect a different mayor.

Raman thanked her family, volunteers and campaign workers, calling their effort "this little campaign that could."

She reminded supporters of her promise that there would be dancing, even as the outcome remained uncertain.

The gathering ended without a declared winner. For Raman's supporters, the question was no longer simply whether she could win, but whether a new mayor could deliver the changes they had come to celebrate.

Suspect arrested in hit-and-run death of 16-year-old pedestrian

From City News Service

LOS ANGELES — The brother of a 16-year-old boy who was killed by a driver who allegedly ran a stop sign and then tried to shake the victim loose from her car's windshield before fleeing on foot, expressed his thanks that the suspect was in custody.

Hernan Martinez died at the scene of the crash, which occurred about 9:35 p.m. Sept. 22 at the intersection of 60th Street at 10th Avenue, according to the Los Angeles Police Department.

Martinez's younger sister, Vicky, was also struck and was critically injured.

Raygine Glentasia Evans, 28, was arrested Oct. 28 in Los Angeles and booked into the county jail, police said.

Evans — who made her first appearance in a downtown Los Angeles courtroom Oct. 29 — was ordered to be held without bail while awaiting arraignment Dec. 2.

She was charged Oct. 8 with one felony count of murder stemming from the boy's death, along with one felony count of reckless driving on a highway causing a specified injury, two felony counts of hit-and-run driving resulting in death or serious injury to another person and one misdemeanor count of hit-and-run driving resulting in property damage, according to the complaint.

The complaint also alleges that Evans has prior convictions for robbery in 2018 and grand theft in 2021.

According to the LAPD, Evans has been cited for reckless driving and running stop signs nine times and was wanted in connection with multiple robberies, including 10 in Los Angeles.

Police allege she was driving a blue 2025 Nissan Sentra eastbound on 60th Street at 10th Avenue when she ran past a stop sign at 80 mph and struck Martinez and his sister.

Hernan's brother, Eliseo Martinez, told reporters his mother was able to pull Vicky away from the car. He said the girl suffered a fractured pelvis and required surgery. The mother was not hit.

At a news conference with police and family members near a memorial at the crash site, Eliseo Martinez said the fact the suspect had been at large weighed heavily on him and his mother.

Police said Evans kept driving until the sedan struck a parked vehicle. She and a female passenger then got out of the Sentra and fled in an unknown direction, authorities said.

The passenger has been identified as Joannae Shavon Rosby, according to police.

Witnesses said the boy's body was lodged in the Sentra's windshield until the sedan struck the parked car.

Detective Ryan Moreno of the LAPD's South Traffic Division, who attended a news conference Oct. 29 announcing the arrest, said the suspect swerved the car in an attempt to dislodge the injured teen from her smashed windshield.

The driver and passenger took some items out of the car before being picked up by someone driving a red Honda Accord, Moreno said.

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Compton, Culver City and Inglewood News

Early election results show Mayor Butts headed to runoff

By Emilie St. John
Contributing Writer

INGLEWOOD — Mayor James T. Butts appears headed to a March runoff with Councilwoman Gloria Gray.

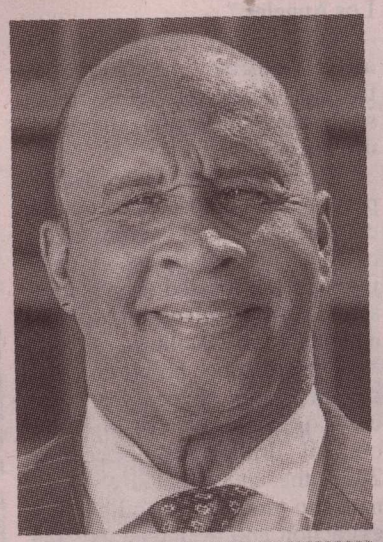
Early election results on the Los Angeles County Registrar's website show Butts trailing Gray by 700 votes.

Butts had 29% of the vote, while Gray had 33%.

The Wave caught up with Butts at his campaign party to speak with him about the importance of this election as he seeks a fifth term in office.

"Here we are at a crossroads in our history — bouncing back from bankruptcy, an 18% unemployment rate to an international city," Butts said. "This election is the most important election since I won in 2010.

"Inglewood is now big enough and valuable enough for



James T. Butts



Gloria Gray

people to want to control it, and the billionaires we have over at Intuit and SoFi Stadium want to control all the advertising revenue and control the taxation of admissions taxes, and they're willing to do anything to make sure that happens."

The owners of the Intuit Dome, SoFi Stadium, and operators of Hollywood Park pledged millions of dollars behind two ballot measures — Measure AT to stop the restructuring of the city's admissions tax, and Measure BB to stop the city from profiting from a 20-year agreement with WOW Media over digital billboards.

"They sued us three times over our advertising kiosks and traffic information network and lost, and the court voided the development agreement with SoFi Stadium, and now they've gone over the courts with Measure BB to disallow the city from advertising and earning $8 million per year, which supports city programming."

According to results posted by the Los Angeles County Registrar-Recorder's Office shortly after 8 a.m. Nov. 4, Measure AT was losing 51% to 49%, a margin of 402 votes, and Measure BB was losing 52% to 48%, a margin of 808.

Measure AT seeks to restructure the city's admissions taxes on venues based on seating capacity and Measure BB seeks to stop the city from earning revenue from digital billboards on the public right-of-way.

Gray, who currently represents Council District 1, declined to run for reelection, opening her seat to four challengers.

Keokia Childress, co-founder of Taste of Inglewood and a city housing commissioner, was the leading vote-getter, receiving 2,399 votes, 40%. Yolanda Davidson, an activist, followed with 1,655 votes, 28%, followed by Leonard Redway with 1,454 votes, 24%, and William Perez with 511 votes, 8%.

District 2 Councilman Alex Padilla soundly defeated his challenger, Subrina Miller, earning 69% of the vote.

In the Inglewood School district advisory board, Joyce Randall appears headed to retain her seat in Area 1, receiving 57% of the vote over Planning Commissioner Cheryl Shaw-Williams, who received 43%.

Joe Bowers received 64% of the vote to win in Area 2, a seat previously held by his late wife, Margaret Bowers. His challenger, Shelby Richardson, received 36%.

Area 3 incumbent Brandon Myers, is trailing his challenger, Yuritze Gonzalez, who received 66% of the vote over Myers' 34%.

Inglewood residents overwhelmingly approved ballot Measure MM for a $396 million bond measure to upgrade and repair schools, despite several school closures in the last two years. The measure passed after capturing 74% of the vote.

In other local races, Assemblywoman Tina McKinnor seemed headed to reelection in the 61st Assembly District. In early results, she had 84% of the vote over challenger Brian Lockwood.

In the West Basin Municipal Water District, Gray was losing her bid for reelection. Tyron Turner was leading Gray, with 41% of the vote, with Gray receiving 37% and Carol Raines-Brown receiving 22%.

"It can be tough to challenge a longtime incumbent," Turner said. "Some people told me not to run, but I believed the community deserved a representative focused on the issues that matter to Second District residents.

"I knocked on more than 3,000 doors and spoke with residents across the district. I'm grateful to everyone who heard me out and supported this campaign, and I'm ready to get to work," he added.

"I'm very pleased with the preliminary results; people are voting for change, but until all the votes are counted we'll continue to hope for the best, and as a first-time candidate, I'm feeling pretty good."

An Inglewood resident is suing Gray for holding incompatible seats as a member of the Inglewood City Council, which buys water from West Basin. Gray missed two scheduled court hearings on the matter and is due back in court next month with an answer to the lawsuit filed against her.

If Turner wins the water board seat, the lawsuits will become moot.

Vote counting is expected to continue throughout the week and all vote totals are unofficial.

Emilie St. John is a freelance journalist covering the areas of Carson, Compton, Inglewood and Willowbrook. Send tips to her at emiliesaintjohn@gmail.com.

Emma Sharif headed for reelection as mayor of Compton

By Emilie St. John
Contributing Writer

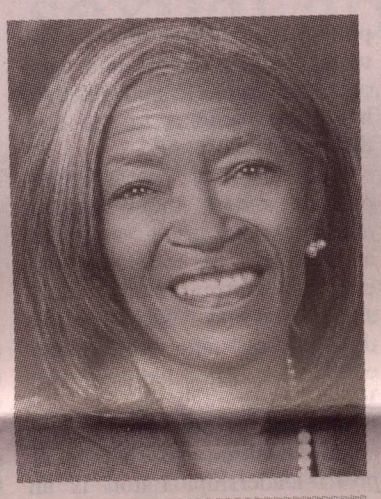
COMPTON — Emma Sharif was is headed to another term as mayor, according to early voting returns.

Early results show Sharif leading her challenger, District 2 Councilman Andre Spicer with 8,728 votes, 65%, to Spicer's 4,713 votes, 35%.

Sharif thanked her supporters in a social media post.

"A special thank you to everyone who came out to celebrate with me, and to everyone who has helped get me to this point," Sharif wrote. "This is not something I could ever do alone — it is something we made possible together as a community. I love each and every one of you who believes in my vision. Let's finish the work we have started."

The Council District 2 seat held by Spicer will have a new representative. Anthony Perry is leading the early returns with 1,400 votes, 54%, followed by Bennie Tenson with 1,218 votes, 46%.



Emma Sharif

Voters in the Compton Community College District had elections in four of the districts seven areas for seats on the Board of Trustees.

In Trustee Area 1, incumbent Andres Ramos defeated former Compton school board member Skyy Fisher, capturing 77% of the vote.

In Trustee Area 2, appointee Nicole Jones received 66% of the vote over Adrian Cleveland.

In Trustee Area 4, incumbent Juanita Doplemore received 51% of the vote over Peter Parker, who received 49%.

Trustee Area 5, incumbent Sharoni Denise Little is trailing Sharon Whitaker, who received 53% of the vote.

Local congressional Rep. Maxine Waters secured reelection after securing 81% of the vote over challenger Christian Morales.

Compton school board member Ayanna Davis had a commanding lead over challenger Lydia Gutierrez in the 65th Assembly District, replacing Assemblyman Mike Gipson, who was termed out of office. Davis secured 80% of the vote.

Gipson was leading in his race for the Third District on the state Board of Equalization. Gibson had more than 59% of the vote, leading Samuel Sukaton.

Early voting numbers indicate that voter turnout was low in the city's primary election.

County Registrar-Recorder Dean Logan said his office received 1.3 ballots, which were processed and counted, with 22.38% of registered voters casting ballots. Those numbers could change as the vote-counting process continues.

Vote counting is expected to continue throughout the week and all vote totals are unofficial.

Emilie St. John is a freelance journalist covering the areas of Carson, Compton, Inglewood and Willowbrook. Send tips to her at emiliesaintjohn@gmail.com.

Judge denies county's bid to dismiss suit in late NFL player's death

From City News Service

LOS ANGELES — The family of Stanley Wilson Jr. can proceed to trial with its case against Los Angeles County in which they allege the 40-year-old ex-NFL player died while in custody in 2023 due to medical negligence, a judge has ruled.

The late cornerback was arrested for trespassing in November 2022 and detained at the Twin Towers Jail. He had been deemed incompetent to stand trial and had a history of mental illness, his family's attorney said at the time.

Los Angeles Superior Court Judge Richard Fruin denied the county's motion to dismiss the family's case Oct. 24 and trial is tentatively scheduled for April 5, 2027.

In their dismissal motion, county attorneys stated that the plaintiffs' case had evolved from one originally alleging excessive force in the government claim to a fourth amended complaint filed in October 2025 contending that Wilson died after getting inadequate medical care after suffering a pulmonary embolism.

"While a complaint may elaborate upon facts disclosed in a government claim, it may not fundamentally shift allegations and premise liability on a wholly different set of operative facts, involving different conduct, different actors, different duties, and a different mechanism of injury," the county attorneys contend. "That is precisely what occurred here."

But the family attorneys explained in their court papers that the switch in theories was reasonable.

"From the outset, Stanley Wilson Jr.'s parents lacked critical information regarding the facts and circumstances of Stanley's death, including video footage that was not produced until 2025," Wilson's family attorneys said. "As such, they timely filed a government claim against [the sheriff's department] on March 14, 2023, based on the limited information they had when they presented the claim, including public reporting at the time."

From the original complaint through the third amended complaint, the Wilson family has consistently said that despite months-long efforts, they had been unable to obtain video footage and information concerning the facts and circumstances of Wilson's death, the Wilson family lawyers wrote.

The family finally obtained the requested video after an order in July 2025, the Wilson attorneys stated in their court papers.

The Stanford University graduate and former Detroit Lions player died on Feb. 1, 2023. The suit filed in September of that year names as defendants the county, the Los Angeles County Sheriff's Department and the Department of State Hospitals.

The family maintains that the county negligently failed to transfer Wilson to Metropolitan State Hospital in Norwalk by a court-ordered deadline and that the alleged medical and custodial failures contributed to the pulmonary embolism that ultimately caused his death.

After playing for Stanford, Wilson was drafted in the third round of the 2005 NFL draft by the Detroit Lions. He played cornerback for three seasons and had 86 tackles during his NFL career before experiencing a knee injury in 2007 and an Achilles injury during the 2008 preseason.

Detectives renew push for clues in killing of community activist

From City News Service

COMPTON — Homicide de-

east of Wilmington Avenue near Compton/Woodley Airport at the New Wilmington Arms Apart-

reward, totaling $70,000, for information leading to the identification, arrest and conviction of the suspects," according to a

erupted.

"It is no surprise that during the moment of this terrible act, Eric was trying to save a com-

others," she wrote. "Through his genuine commitment to service, Mr. Washington connected residents to vital resources, inspired young people, and helped build

Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass described Washington as a "devoted public servant" following his death.

"Eric chose a life of humble

LOS ANGELES WAVE
COMMUNITY
Los Angeles and South Los Angeles

Bass signs ordinance to phase out oil drilling in city

FROM CITY NEWS SERVICE

LOS ANGELES — Mayor Karen Bass signed a new oil and gas drilling ordinance Oct. 29, marking a milestone for the city in its efforts to phase out oil drilling and protect neighborhoods.

Bass' approval comes a day after the City Council advanced the measure. The gas and oil ordinance mandates that all existing oil and gas activities are a nonconforming use in all zones.

Any oil and gas activities would be phased out within a 20-year period unless authorized by the city as an approved "well maintenance, well servicing exception and/or health and safety exception," according to city documents.

"For too long, communities throughout Los Angeles have lived with the impacts of oil and gas drilling in their neighborhoods, leading to significant health conditions. We're changing this," Bass said.

"I have fought for environmental justice throughout my career, from the state Assembly to Congress and now as mayor. Signing this ordinance is another important step toward phasing out oil and gas drilling in Los Angeles once and for all," Bass added.

The ordinance also creates a separate review process to permit such activities only to prevent, respond to or cease credible threats to public health, safety or the environment.



Oil derricks pump oil in the Inglewood Oil Field. Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass has signed a city ordinance that labels all existing oil and gas activities as nonconforming use in all areas of the city. Under the ordinance, all oil and gas activities in the city would be phased out within a 20-year period unless authorized by the city.

File photo

"No one should have to live near an oil drilling site. In South L.A., working-class families have had corporations drilling across the street from their homes," Council President Marqueece Harris-Dawson said in a statement. "Today's vote marks a historic step forward for environmental justice and public health in Los Angeles."

Oil drilling operations can affect nearby neighborhoods through emissions, odors, noise, spills, truck traffic and other land-use impacts.

Those burdens have disproportionately impacted frontline communities and communities of color, particularly where drilling sites are located near homes, schools, parks, places of worship and health care facilities.

The ordinance builds on years of community advocacy and the city's previous efforts to phase out oil drilling. In December 2022, the city adopted an ordinance to prohibit new oil and gas extraction and designate existing operations as nonconforming uses. Following legal challenges, the ordinance was rescinded after a court ruling.

State lawmakers subsequently passed AB 3233, reaffirming local authority to regulate or prohibit oil and gas development. The updated ordinance uses that authority to reestablish the citywide approach to phasing out oil and gas drilling.

"For more than a decade, residents across Los Angeles have been fighting for something pretty straightforward: Oil wells do not belong next to their homes, schools and daycare centers," Councilwoman Katy Yaroslavsky said in a statement.

City officials also thanked Stand Together Against Neighborhood Drilling, or STAND-LA, for its 14 years of work on the issue.

"Now we need to finish the job by making sure these wells are properly plugged, these sites are cleaned up and the companies responsible are held accountable," Yaroslavsky added.

"After over a decade, Black and Latino frontline communities have a commitment from their city leaders that their health and their communities have value, and a promise that they will be protected," said Rev. Victor Cyrus-Franklin, lead pastor at Holman United Methodist Church. "It has been a long time coming and a change has come to South L.A. This ushers L.A. closer to a new era of environmental justice."

STAND-LA issued a statement acknowledging Bass and the City Council for supporting the ordinance.

"While this is an important step, signing this ordinance today is not the end, but instead the start of the city's commitment to environmental justice," the statement said. "Tomorrow, frontline residents will still wake up next to drilling in their neighborhoods — and will continue to advocate for city leaders to protect their health from toxic oil pollution."

Alliance of Women Directors charts its own path in film

BY DARLENE DONLOE
Contributing Writer

HOLLYWOOD — In 1997, a handful of women walked out of the American Film Institute's Directing Workshop for Women and did what women in Hollywood have always had to do — they built their own room. They were graduates of the institute, trained, talented and still locked out of the jobs.

So they started swapping information. Who's hiring? Who's not? How to get a second meeting? How to survive the first one?

That informal circle became the Alliance of Women Directors.

Accomplished actress, director and professor emeritus at USC's School of Cinematic Arts, Jennifer Warren, part of the initial collective, is the founder and co-chair of the alliance. She launched the organization in 1997, after experiencing firsthand the gender barriers women face moving from acting to directing.

Decades later, that circle is a nonprofit organization with 900 members — an inclusive collective of professional women and gender-expansive directors and allies who have decided parity will not be given. It will be organized.

At the center is Kylie Eaton, 40, a married mother of a 3-year-old daughter, and graduate of the Film School at Chapman University in Orange.

Darlene Donloe is a freelance reporter for Wave Newspapers who covers South Los Angeles. She can be reached at ddonloe@gmail.com.

She is a nonprofit leader dedicated to advancing equity and expanding career opportunities, and currently serves as executive director of the alliance, supporting women and gender-expansive directors in film, television, commercials and new media.

"We are relentless advocates for gender parity and we believe it is vital that stories are told from all perspectives because representation matters," said Eaton, who did not arrive at the top from the outside.

Prior to becoming executive director, she served three terms on the alliance board, including as treasurer and co-chair, helping guide growth, strengthen governance and expand reach.

Since assuming leadership, Eaton has led strategic growth, expanded professional development and mentorship, strengthened partnerships with studios, networks and industry organizations, and significantly increased membership and fundraising.

That fundraising now includes the alliance's 2026 CharityBuzz Auction, live virtually through December. Filmmakers can bid on one-of-a-kind access — career consultations, mentorship sessions, script and reel feedback, coffee meetings, set visits and shadowing opportunities with directors, showrunners, producers, executives, agents and managers working in film and television today. Every bid supports the alliance's work advancing women and gender-expansive directors.

That is the builder's work Eaton is know for — hands-on and practical — and it mirrors her work as a filmmaker. The alliance boasts substantially increasing the number of women and gender-expansive directors working.



Kylie Eaton

Eaton said it's accomplished by "working with our members and getting them trained."

"There's a couple of different ways that our members are trained," Eaton said. "We do some virtual workshops because our membership is nationwide and we want to be accessible to women all over the country and all over the world because we have some international members."

Eaton said the organization also "pairs members for shadowing opportunities, so they go onto real sets to shadow either on a TV set or an indie movie, shadowing the director through pre-production, production, post, and all facets of directing."

Eaton said directors need to put new work on their reel every year and people can't always afford that.

"This year we partnered with a stage and got free equipment and set our directors up so that they could work with writers and create scenes," she said. "This fall, we're doing a cinematography workshop."

There's also a hands-on component where directors can talk to technical directors and camera manufacturers and get their hands on cameras to see how different lenses look.

"We also have a yearly symposium and a mock general meeting where you go and meet an executive, not to pitch a project, you're forming that relationship, Eaton said. "We had people do it live on stage with real executives and then get feedback. We've done blocking exercises live in front of 200 people."

In addition to her nonprofit leadership, Eaton is an award-winning filmmaker whose work has screened at Oscar-qualifying festivals, debuted on Dust, an artificial intelligence agency; and earned recognition from WeScreenplay, Blackmagic Collective, ScreenCraft and Shore Scripts.

She began directing music videos and branded content for Capitol Records, Republic Records, Oliver Peoples and Beachbody, garnering more than 40 million views.

She has spoken at Sundance and HollyShorts, programmed and judged for Bushwick, WomenX and MOM Film Fest, and serves on the board of the BRIC Foundation.

That dual identity — working director, nonprofit strategist, and mother — defines how she leads the alliance. The organization's commitment is threefold: support through craft enrichment, education and mentorship; developing relationships with industry partners; and partnering with like-minded organizations.

Its members range from recent graduates with a single acclaimed short to seasoned, award-winning veterans. Each has directed at least one long or short-form narrative film, TV episode, documentary, commercial or new media program recognized by the creative community.

To attack the gap, Eaton built infrastructure. She is founder of the alliance's Rising Director Fellowship for emerging feature directors; Back to Set, its annual symposium; and its fiscal sponsorship program, which has enabled filmmakers to raise more than $2 million.

Asked why female directors should join her alliance, Eaton said, "We've been around for almost 30 years, and our mission is to advocate for women and gender expansive directors and film, TV, and new media.

"We do that through supporting our members with professional development, workshops, labs, panels, to create opportunities to learn more about craft and gain access to a wider network," she added.

Reasons to join include mentorship, craft enrichment and networking.

"We also have ally membership, which is open to all genders in all professions," Eaton said. "There are a lot of people who are in the film industry who want to meet more directors, producers, writers, actors, and different department heads that want to find new collaborators. We do a lot of mixers."

Eaton said it's no secret there is a lack of women directors.

"The most recent studies for 2025 show that only 8% of top films were directed by women, which is a backslide — as well as in TV," Eaton said. "There has been a similar backslide, with only 22% of directors and 16% of directors in broadcast TV being women. And then if you start looking at women of color, it's exponentially less."

That backslide is why the alliance created the Black Directors Advancement Initiative. It is deliberately simple and personal: a one-to-one relationship between an industry mentor and a Black alliance director.

The mission: create relationships, promote development, facilitate successful interactions and help eliminate barriers that have systematically excluded Black directors.

"The initiative was born in 2020 out of a town hall that we held as an organization, and really after hearing the feedback from our Black director members," Eaton said. "There are extra barriers that they face on top of being a woman.

"There is extra bias that they face every day and that's tripled on set and so we formed this initiative to be able to offer some extra support," she added. It's really about equity. They're just as talented as every other member. It's just about getting access and meeting the right person who is going to take a chance on them."

Industry mentors are paired by focus — episodic directing, general relationship building and career advice or shooting a feature — because those are precisely the choke points where Black women get stalled.

If no one will share information, share it yourselves. If no one will open the door, build a door. That was the lesson in 1997. It is still the lesson in 2026, with Eaton holding the door open for more than 900 directors who know parity is not a pipeline problem.

LOS ANGELES WAVE

STATE/NATION

NAACP state convention concludes with call to action

By Edward Henderson
Contributing Writer

LONG BEACH — The NAACP California-Hawaii State Conference concluded its 39th annual convention Oct. 25, reaffirming its commitment to civil rights, civic engagement and economic equity.

Held Oct. 22–25 under the theme "We the People: Will Not Be Deterred," the convention brought together NAACP members from local branches and youth and college units across California and Hawaii.

"We come together at a critical moment," state President Rick L. Callender said in his welcome statement. "Our civil rights, voting rights, educational opportunities, economic security, history, and democracy continue to face serious challenges. This is not the time to become discouraged or distracted. It is the time to become even more determined."



Assemblyman Corey Jackson, incoming chair of the California Legislative Black Caucus, speaks at the NAACP California Hawaii State Conference. The conference was held in Long Beach from Oct. 22 to 25.

Photo courtesy of NAACP

Elected officials, community leaders, labor representatives and young people also attended the four-day convention, participating in discussions, workshops and celebrations focused on issues affecting Black communities and other communities of color.

Among guests were U.S. Sen. Adam Schiff, D-California; U.S. Rep. Maxine Waters, D-Los Angeles; state Superintendent of Public Instruction Tony Thurmond; civil rights attorney John L. Burris; J. Luke Wood, Cal State Sacramento president; and LaNiece Jones, president and CEO of Black Women Organized for Political Action.

"'We Are in the Thick of It,' underscores the urgency of collaboration and collective action," Jones said. "We have a tremendous opportunity to strengthen partnerships between NAACP CA/HI, BWOPA California, sororities/fraternities and Black-led community organizations statewide — expanding civic engagement, developing future leaders, and continuing to build Black political power."

"Our organizations were not created simply to sustain themselves; we were created to sustain our people's will to progress," Jones added.

The California-Hawaii State Conference coordinates advocacy, organizing and community engagement through its regional network of branches in both states.

The annual convention provides an opportunity for members and leaders to assess progress, establish priorities and strengthen partnerships, according to organizers.

This year's gathering explored the connections between civil rights, political participation, environmental justice and economic opportunity, emphasizing the importance of turning advocacy into meaningful community improvements.

In a statement provided to California Black Media, Callender emphasized that the convention's conclusion marked the beginning of another phase of the organization's work.

"Our 39th annual convention in Long Beach sent a clear message: We will not be deterred," Callender said. "Now it's time to act. Get our communities to the polls on November 3. Defend our civil rights. Advance the priorities of Black communities and other communities of color in 2027 and beyond. The convention is over. The work continues."

Environmental and climate justice and economic development were central themes, with discussions focusing on addressing environmental disparities affecting underserved communities, strengthening protections and expanding economic opportunities through community investment and sustainable development.

Members also addressed the organizational strength needed to sustain this work, including strengthening local branches, expanding membership and ensuring the state conference remains equipped to advocate effectively for its communities.

Political participation and the relationship between civil rights advocacy and organized labor also figured prominently. The Political & Labor Luncheon provided a forum for conversations about political leadership, civic engagement and the role of labor organizations in advancing shared priorities

Assemblyman Mike Gipson, D-Gardena, reflected on this year's convention in an Instagram post, expressing appreciation for the opportunity to participate alongside fellow advocates.

"You make me grateful to be among leaders dedicated to advancing equity, civil rights, and stronger communities," Gipson wrote.

The emphasis on voting carried particular significance as Callender challenged members to translate the convention's conversations into voter outreach, community organizing and continued advocacy. He also urged attendees to vote – and turn their ballots in early, if possible.

Youth leadership was another important component of the gathering. Programming organized by the Youth and College Division engaged younger members in discussions about leadership, civic responsibility and the future of the civil rights movement, reinforcing the importance of preparing the next generation of advocates.

The convention also recognized individuals whose contributions have helped advance civil rights and strengthen communities. The convention program identified Burris as the honoree at the 16th annual Legacy Hall of Fame Awards Dinner. Veterans also were honored, while a prayer and memorial breakfast provided an opportunity to remember those whose contributions helped shape the movement.

"When we say, 'We the People: Will Not Be Deterred,' we mean that we will continue to organize, advocate, educate and hold institutions accountable … and prepare for the work that must continue long after this convention ends," Callender said.

Edward Henderson writes for California Black Media.

Big-city mayors want $1 billion to fight homelessness

California Black Media

RIVERSIDE — The bipartisan California Big City Mayors coalition called on the next governor and Legislature to guarantee at least $1 billion annually in homelessness funding, expand mental health treatment and rein in litigation costs straining municipal budgets during an Oct. 30 summit at Riverside City Hall.

With affordable housing at the forefront of their agenda, the mayors also endorsed Proposition 1, an $11.25 billion housing bond that was on the Nov. 3 ballot, emphasizing the need for sustained state investment to address California's housing and homelessness crises.

The 13-city coalition represents nearly 11 million residents and advocates for stronger state-local partnerships on housing, public safety and economic development.

California's affordability gap underscores the urgency. According to the California Association of Realtors, just 19% of households could afford the state's median-priced single-family home, costing nearly $895,000, in the third quarter of 2026. Buyers needed approximately $228,000 in annual income. Nationally, 39% of households could afford a median-priced home.

Proposition 1 would support affordable rental construction and preservation, homeownership assistance and housing for vulnerable populations. State analysts estimate it could help subsidize up to 40,000 multifamily units and assist roughly 40,000 households with homeownership.

The mayors stressed that housing for formerly unhoused people must be paired with treatment and prevention.

"Housing alone will not solve this crisis," Stockton Mayor Christina Fugazi said. Cities, she explained, increasingly respond to psychiatric emergencies and addiction without sufficient resources to ensure continuing care.

Riverside Mayor Patricia Lock Dawson, coalition chair, said the summit would turn shared priorities into a legislative agenda.

The state's Homeless Housing, Assistance and Prevention (HHAP) program finances shelters, outreach, interim housing, prevention and permanent housing. Although California provided approximately $890 million for its seventh funding round, future appropriations remain uncertain.

Mayors want at least $1 billion annually through multiyear commitments, with flexible local spending and measurable results.

"We set out to restore HHAP funding, and we've accomplished that," Dawson said. "But restoring HHAP funding was just the beginning."

"Cities can't build a long-term solution to homelessness on a year-to-year funding commitment," San Jose Mayor Matt Mahan said. "We need predictable resources, clear performance measures and the flexibility to invest in programs that are actually moving people off the streets and into stable housing."

Asked by California Black Media whether the proposed housing bond would link CARE Court, treatment and housing assistance, he said it would not do so automatically.



Long Beach Mayor Rex Richardson addresses the rising cost of lawsuits against California cities during a California Big City Mayors news conference at Riverside City Hall Oct. 29. Richardson joined mayors from across the state in calling for reforms to curb excessive litigation costs that drain taxpayer resources and threaten funding for essential public services.

Photo courtesy of California Black Media

"We have a lot of new tools and a lot of funding streams," Mahan said, calling for public reporting on when promised treatment facilities open and whether programs work together.

Asked whether a state audit could identify gaps, he replied, "Possibly. Could be an ask."

Fresno Mayor Jerry Dyer, coalition vice chair, cited a 23% decline in homelessness across the Fresno-Madera Continuum of Care over four years. Fresno has built about 1,300 affordable units, with 1,400 more planned or underway, he said. Of those served, 53% achieved a "safe exit," including housing or family reunification.

"We cannot afford to go backwards," Dyer said.

The mayors also want clearer treatment referrals, more capacity and stronger coordination among cities, counties and state agencies.

Another pressure point is litigation. An August Pepperdine University and Beacon Economics analysis found California public-entity liability costs had tripled over seven years. A separate analysis covering more than 1,900 public agencies put annual claims costs at approximately $1.2 billion in 2025, up from $392 million in 2018. Those figures include counties, schools and special districts, not cities alone.

San Diego Mayor Todd Gloria cited a $35 million trip-and-fall claim against the city — a claim, not a judgment — and argued that settlements, insurance and legal costs reduce money available for public services.

Anaheim Mayor Ashleigh Aitken said HHAP helped nearly 500 people move into permanent housing. She highlighted the Tampico Hotel, which houses young adults, including former foster youth.

"Spending to reduce homelessness is one of the best investments we make and it is time to make it permanent," Aitken said.

Irvine Mayor Larry Agran emphasized homelessness prevention as living costs rise. He said locally operated outreach, interim housing and prevention programs need continued flexible support, not replacement by new construction funding.

The mayors also demanded faster implementation of behavioral health reforms, including CARE Court and a separate Proposition 1 approved in 2024. That $6.4 billion bond was intended to expand treatment facilities and supportive housing, with original goals including 6,800 residential beds and 26,700 outpatient slots.

Mahan said San Jose has built more than 2,000 interim housing units and reduced unsheltered homelessness 32% in 18 months, yet thousands remain outdoors.

Long Beach Mayor Rex Richardson said his city's insurance costs climbed from $10.5 million to nearly $23 million in three years. Both mayors urged reforms that preserve fair compensation for injured residents while limiting excessive municipal exposure.

The coalition plans to press its housing, homelessness, treatment and liability priorities during the 2027 legislative session.

Dawson said the objective is "identifying the issues our cities cannot solve alone and working directly with the governor and Legislature to advance meaningful, statewide solutions."

State's first Black finance director to lead high-speed rail project

California Black Media

accountability back to the multi-billion-dollar bullet train project.

budget proposals. He was appointed by the governor in July 2022.

"The governor is grateful for that service and confident Joe is the

reaching top speeds of 220 miles per hour.

Since its approval by voters

LOS ANGELES WAVE
VOICES

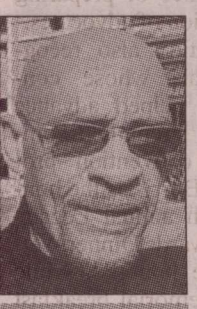
THE HUTCHINSON REPORT

Recall petition is a wake-up call for Harris-Dawson

By Earl Ofari Hutchinson
Contributing Columnist

The announcement that a group of residents of the 8th City Council District have filed a petition to recall Los Angeles City Council President Marqueece Harris-Dawson.

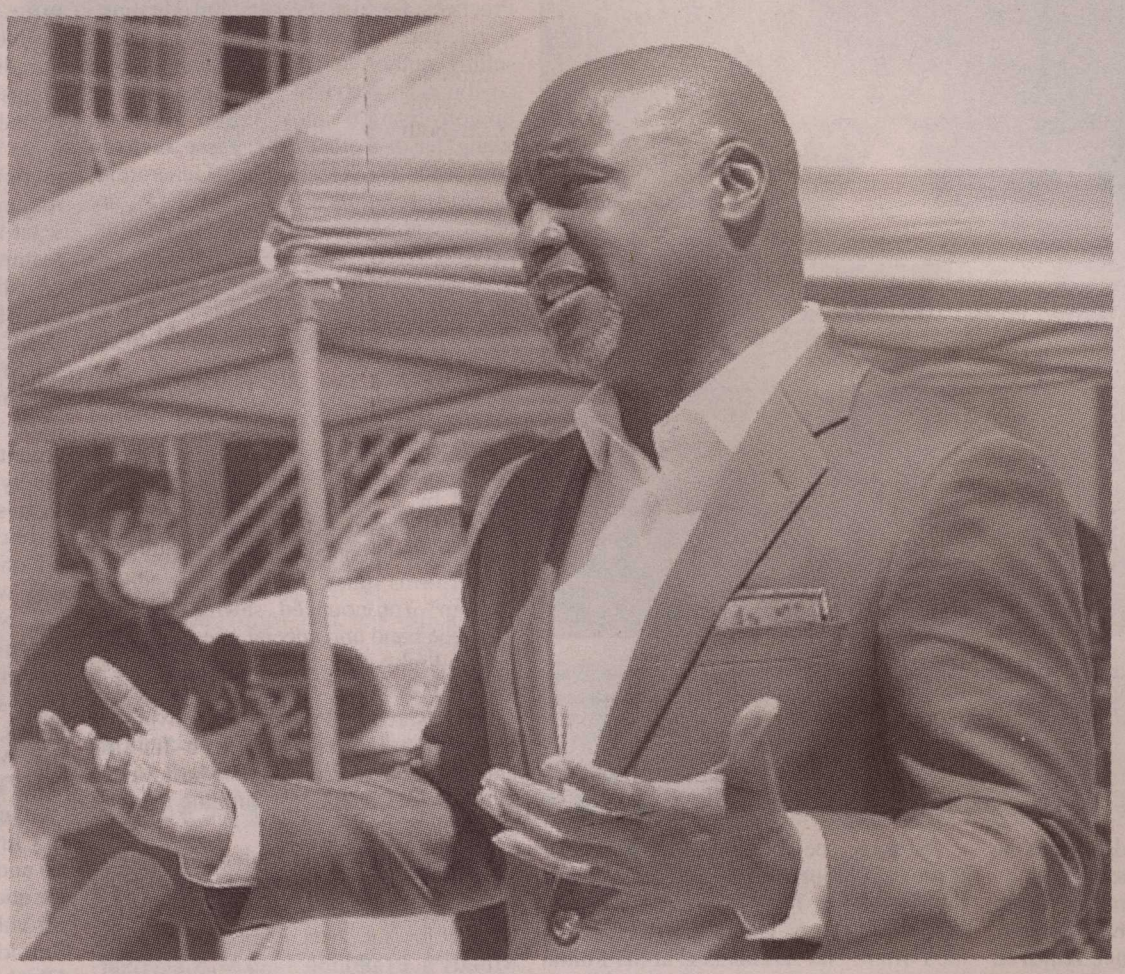
It was only a matter of time that Harris-Dawson would be targeted because of the almost non-stop complaints I have heard from many residents about him. They blame him for almost institutionalized illegal street dumping in the district, chronic dirty streets, equally chronic joblessness, rampant business closures, widespread homeless encampments, and his alleged do-nothingness in fulfilling his promise to pour millions into a remake of a vital section of the Crenshaw District dubbed Destination Crenshaw.


Hutchinson

The Harris-Dawson antagonists have until February to corral the required number of valid signatures to get a recall measure on the ballot.

Harris-Dawson gave the recall drive short shrift with a defiant statement, "My focus is squarely on serving the residents of 8th District and leading the City Council. With so many pressing issues facing our communities, there is no time for distractions."

The operative word in his punch back statement was "distractions." He clearly views the recall effort as little more than a not-so-veiled attempt to hamper his ongoing work in the district. The "distraction" angle will almost certainly be his major point of attack if the recall manages to gain steam.


Los Angeles City Council President Marqueece Harris-Dawson is the target of a recall campaign in the 8th City Council District. Columnist Earl Ofari Hutchinson says the campaign is due to the deteriorating conditions in the district and should serve as a wake-up call for Harris-Dawson.

File photo

At first glance, it appears that Harris-Dawson can easily ride out a recall effort. Recalling an elected official is a tough ladder to scale. First, voters must gather signatures from registered voters equal to 15% of the votes cast in the last election for that office. The exact figure in the 8th District is 21,569 valid signatures needed from registered voters in the district.

Next, the council member's opponents must file a notice of intention and gather the required signatures. Then they must submit the recall petition to the city clerk for verification. Finally, the petition must be verified. Only then can a recall election be held.

That's just the start. The burden now falls heavily on the recall proponents. They must raise bushels of cash to publicize the recall. They must state their case in plain language why the council member should be recalled. Then they must batten down the hatches and try to weather the storm of support the council member will get from many voters in the district that backed him or her.

That's not to mention the massive orchestration by the council member of counter advertising and support attacking the recall proponents while back patting his or herself on the all the bountiful things that he did for district residents.

Harris-Dawson will do all of that and more. He will almost certainly have the solid backing of the full City Council that he presides over.

After all, they have a vested interest in ensuring he goes nowhere. If he's successfully recalled today, it could be them tomorrow. That's to say some of their disgruntled constituents might get ideas about ousting them too.

But there are two possible pluses the recall proponents have. One is the very fact that things came to the point where they were angered enough at the alleged failings of Harris-Dawson to even file a recall petition. That indicates there is not just concern but real dissatisfaction with his performance in office from at least some of his constituents. That alone should be worrisome for him.

The other plus is the embarrassment that a recall petition stirs. No elected official wants to be the target of a campaign to oust them when they are in office, especially if they have been in the office for any significant period of time.

That's certainly true with Harris-Dawson. He's now midway through his third term. In fact, in a couple more years he'll be termed out. The recall petition is a direct slap in his face and casts a long negative shadow over his years and work in the district.

The real question in any serious effort to oust a well-established elected official is how widespread and deep the discontent is and how effective the elected official can be in beating back the effort to remove him or her. These are X factors in a recall campaign.

And given the high hurdles that must be leaped over to mount a serious recall campaign, it makes a recall a dicey proposition. It's one of the major reasons recall efforts are extremely rare. In the few cases that get off the ground and go to the ballot, they almost never succeed.

If nothing else, a recall campaign does demonstrate that an elected official's constituents do have a potentially potent tool to voice their displeasure over the alleged shortcoming of their representation. It also serves as a huge wake up call to the elected official that he or she must pay much closer attention to what their constituents are saying about them.

And more importantly, they must make maximum effort to do what their constituents demand they do on their behalf. Harris-Dawson got that wake-up call.

Earl Ofari Hutchinson is an author and political analyst. His forthcoming book is "Undoing the Trump Legacy" (Amazon ebook and Middle Passage Press).

Don't allow the clock to be turned back on fair lending

By Marc H. Morial
Guest Columnist

Black mortgage applicants continue to be denied loans at higher rates than white applicants.

The National Urban League has spent more than a century fighting for economic opportunity. We know that access to capital changes lives.


Morial

A mortgage can help a family build generational wealth. A small business loan can turn a dream into a thriving enterprise. Fair and affordable credit can determine whether someone purchases their first home, expands a business, pays for an education or weathers a financial emergency.

But for much of American history, those opportunities were deliberately denied to Black Americans, women and other groups through discriminatory lending practices. It took decades of determined struggle to tear down those barriers and enact protections that required lenders to judge applicants on their qualifications rather than the color of their skin, their gender, or their ZIP code.

Now the Trump administration is trying to undo that progress.

That is why the National Urban League and the Massachusetts Association of Community Development Corporations have gone to court to challenge the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau's rollback of critical protections under Regulation B, the federal regulation that enforces the Equal Credit Opportunity Act. These changes are not technical adjustments. They represent one of the most significant assaults on fair lending protections in decades.

This administration is attempting to dismantle safeguards that have protected Americans from discrimination in lending for more than 50 years. It is inviting financial institutions to abandon practices that help ensure equal access to credit and making it harder to challenge lending policies that disproportionately harm communities of color, women, and other protected groups.

The administration wants Americans to believe these protections are relics of another era.

They are not. Discrimination in lending did not disappear. It evolved.

Today, Black mortgage applicants continue to be denied loans at higher rates than white applicants. The Black-white homeownership gap remains even wider than it was in 1960.

Black entrepreneurs continue to confront barriers to capital. Women continue to face discriminatory lending practices. And increasingly, decisions about who receives credit are being made by algorithms and artificial intelligence systems that can replicate and amplify existing biases. The need for strong fair lending protections is not shrinking — it's growing.

One of the most dangerous changes eliminates a longstanding tool known as disparate-impact liability. This principle recognizes an obvious reality: discrimination is not always announced with a racist memo or a discriminatory policy statement. Sometimes discrimination occurs through supposedly neutral practices that produce predictable and unjustified barriers for certain groups.

For example, suppose a bank adopts a policy refusing to make mortgages under $150,000. The policy never mentions race. It sounds neutral.

But because generations of redlining and discrimination depressed home values in many Black neighborhoods, it disproportionately shuts qualified Black families out of the mortgage market.

Exclusionary zoning and local zoning laws that prohibit multifamily housing or require large minimum lot sizes never mention race. However, because households of color generally have lower average wealth and income due to historical discrimination, these rules can effectively exclude many Black and Latino families from high-opportunity neighborhoods.

Disparate-impact protections recognize that discrimination doesn't always announce itself. Sometimes it hides behind policies that appear neutral while producing barriers that are both foreseeable and unnecessary.

Without disparate-impact protections, lenders face less pressure to examine whether their decisions are unfairly shutting people out of opportunity. The result will not be a freer market. It will be a less accountable one.

The administration is also weakening provisions that discourage lenders from avoiding certain communities and restricting programs specifically designed to expand access to credit where disparities have been documented. These programs have helped families buy homes, helped entrepreneurs launch businesses, and helped communities recover from generations of exclusion.

The message from Washington seems clear: If discrimination becomes harder to prove and easier to ignore, then government no longer considers it a priority. We reject that message.

Every generation faces moments when it must decide whether the nation will move forward or backward. The effort to dismantle Regulation B is a step backward. It threatens to weaken protections that have helped millions of Americans pursue the American dream and build a more inclusive economy.

The National Urban League is proud to join this fight because we know what is at stake. We have seen firsthand how fair access to credit transforms lives, strengthens communities, and expands opportunity.

The administration may want to turn back the clock, but we are determined to make sure it doesn't.

Marc H. Morial is the president and CEO of the National Urban League.

Mixing religion and politics is dangerous combination

uphold? Or are we to believe he